

TENSES

What are Tenses?

Tenses show the time of an action or state of being.

They tell us when something happens.

Examples:

I eat → present time

I ate → past time

I will eat → future time

In English, there are three main tenses:

Present

Past

Future

Each of these has different forms. One important group is called Simple Tenses.

What is the Simple Tense Form?

The simple tense is used to talk about:

Daily habits

General facts

Completed actions in the past

Actions that will happen in the future

There are three simple tenses:

Simple Present Tense

Simple Past Tense

Simple Future Tense

1. Simple Present Tense

Use:

Daily routines

Habits

Universal truths

Form:

Subject + base verb

(Add –s / –es with he, she, it)

Examples:

I play football.

She plays the piano.

The sun rises in the east.

Sentences:

We go to school every day.

He likes ice cream.

2. Simple Past Tense

Use:

Actions completed in the past

Form:

Subject + past form of verb

Examples:

I watched a movie.

She wrote a letter.

They won the match.

Sentences:

We visited our grandparents yesterday.

He ate an apple.

3. Simple Future Tense

Use:

Actions that will happen in the future

Form:

Subject + will + base verb

Examples:

I will study tomorrow.

She will help me.
They will travel next week.

Sentences:

We will complete our homework.

He will become a doctor.

Examples of One Verb in All Simple Tenses

(Verb: to read)

Tense	Sentence
Simple Present	I read books daily.
Simple Past	I read a book yesterday.
Simple Future	I will read a book tomorrow.

Class Exercises

Exercise 1: Fill in the blanks

(use the correct simple tense form)

She ____ (play) tennis every evening.

We ____ (finish) the work yesterday.

I ____ (go) to the market tomorrow.

He ____ (write) a letter last night.

They ____ (eat) lunch at 1 p.m. every day.

Book References

New oxfords English book 1

Essential English Grammar – Raymond Murphy